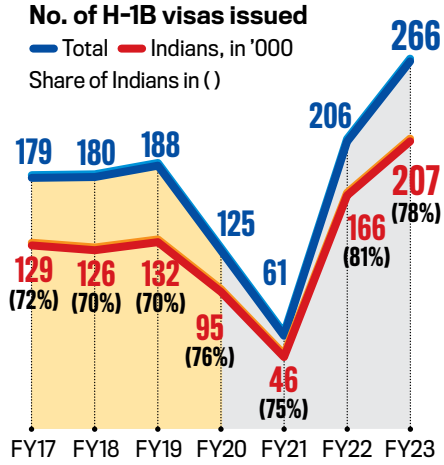
INDIAN SUPREMACY

Indians remain the biggest beneficiaries of H-1B visas



Note: Figures rounded off; include new visas, extensions and change of status to H-1B; the US financial year is from Oct. 1-Sept. 30



TRUMP 1.0
Jan. '17-Jan. '21

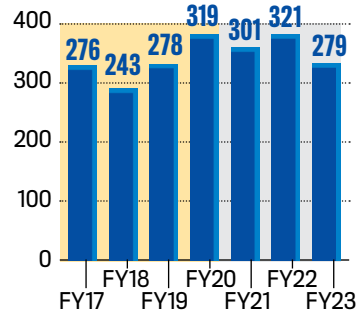


BIDEN
Jan. '21-Jan. '25

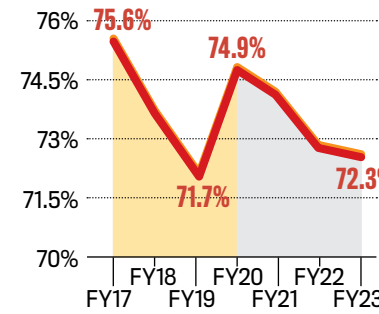
TRUMP VS BIDEN: THE RECORD

H-1B denial rate surged to 24% amid tightened norms during Trump 1.0. Relaxed policies under Biden saw it come down drastically to 2-4 per cent

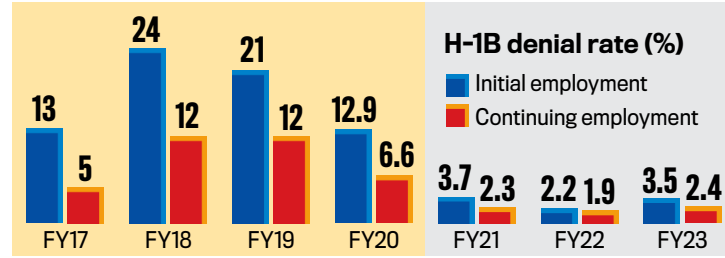
H-1B petitions approved for Indians (in '000)



Share of Indians in total approved petitions



Note: More than one employer can file a petition for a single worker due to which the number of petitions exceed the number of visas issued



Note: Initial employment petitions are for new employment; continuing employment petitions cover extensions or amendments

Source: US Citizenship & Immigration Services/ Bureau of Consular Affairs

THE TOP FIRMS

Firms with most H-1B visas issued to their employees (Apr.-Sept. 2024)

Amazon.com	9,265
Infosys	8,140
Cognizant	6,321
Google	5,364
TCS	5,274
Meta	4,844
Microsoft	4,725
Apple	3,873
HCL America	2,953
IBM	2,906

Source: US Citizenship & Immigration Services

TRUMP'S TWISTS

- Had taken a hardline stance against H-1B visas in his first term
- Introduced significant regulations including tougher scrutiny of petitions
- Pushed for reforms to ensure visas are awarded only to the most-skilled or highest-paid beneficiaries
- But recently told reporters, "I have always felt we have to have the most competent people in our country. We need a lot of people coming in"

WHAT TO EXPECT IN TRUMP 2.0

- Trump may adopt what Project 2025, a conservative blueprint written by many of his former administration officials, advocates as "a gradual and predictable phasedown of the visas"
- Many skilled workers from India could lose their jobs in America, forcing their departure from there

